BUYER INTELLIGENCE PROGRAM

Health System Buyer Personas

A research-driven intelligence library mapping the executive stakeholders, competing pressures, and decision architectures inside complex health system buying cycles.

12	4	150+	120+
PERSONAS	ENGINES	SOURCE REPORTS	JOB POSTINGS ANALYZED

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Four-Step Intelligence Process

Integrating market intelligence, real-world job data, and Gartner frameworks into actionable buyer profiles.

01 TARGETED DISCOVERY

Curated high-impact primary research, executive surveys, and industry outlooks spanning 2020 to 2025. Leveraged 150+ reports from high-authority stakeholders to ensure data integrity.

WittKieffer · HIMSS · HFMA · Bain & Co. · KLAS · Deloitte · Chartis

02 SYNTHESIS & VERIFICATION

Combined insights from 10-15 distinct source documents per persona to establish baseline trends. Cross-referenced findings against 10-12 verified job postings per role to validate current market requirements, reporting structures, and hiring criteria.

03 FRAMEWORK APPLICATION

Structured insights into actionable profiles using Gartner's Buyer Persona and Job-Based Buying Journey Template. Mapped attributes including job titles, relationships, competencies, goals, barriers, decision criteria, and preferred content types.

04 NARRATIVE INTEGRATION

Contextualized personas within the broader health system environment using the Four Engines model. Converted static profiles into a full narrative highlighting cross-functional tensions and strategic drivers.

MARKET CONTEXT

Every Leader Operates in a Crucible of Unprecedented Pressure

Five forces shape every enterprise decision. Understanding them is table stakes.

Financial Instability

Maintaining financial viability amid high-cost operating models, inflationary pressures, and constrained reimbursement.

Workforce Crisis

Persistent staffing shortages, high levels of clinician burnout, and escalating labor expenses destabilizing care delivery.

Operational Gridlock

Capacity constraints, patient throughput limitations, and the challenge of unifying operations after M&A activity.

Digital & Security Threats

Balancing digital transformation with the mission-critical need to protect patient data from evolving cyber threats.

Landscape Volatility

Growing competition from new entrants (retail, PE) and rapidly evolving regulatory requirements creating uncertainty.

THE FOUR ENGINES FRAMEWORK

A Command Center, Not a Hierarchy

Every major decision requires alignment across leaders with fundamentally incompatible success metrics.

DIGITAL & STRATEGIC ENGINE

Where are we going, and how will we get there safely?

- Strategic Tech Leadership
- Strategy Executive
- Information Security Leadership

VALUE & VIABILITY ENGINE

Will we be financially viable tomorrow?

- Chief Financial Officer
- Revenue Cycle Leadership
- Population Health Leadership

OPERATIONS & ACCESS ENGINE

Can we run efficiently today?

- Operations Leadership
- Patient Access Leadership
- Health System Pharmacy Leadership

CARE & QUALITY ENGINE

Are we delivering safe, quality care while reducing burnout?

- Chief Clinical Executive
- Clinical Informatics Leadership
- Medical School Executive

The Digital & Strategic Engine

This engine shapes the future and protects the organization as it evolves. Its leaders connect market trends, technology, and security into a single direction. They are responsible for the platforms that enable scale, the strategy that guides growth, and the defenses that protect the system from digital threats.

KEY TENSIONS

Innovation Investing in new digital capabilities	**Stability** Maintaining legacy infrastructure
Agility Moving quickly on new initiatives	**Governance** Ensuring proper oversight and security
Growth Pursuing strategic partnerships	**Risk** Managing cybersecurity and integration risks

PERSONA COMPARISON

The Leaders Building the Future

	STRATEGIC TECH LEADERSHIP	STRATEGY EXECUTIVE	INFO SECURITY LEADERSHIP
Core Mandate	Makes sure technology works for the system, deciding what gets bought and how systems fit together.	Focused on where the organization is going in 5+ years, connecting market trends and digital strategy.	Protects patient data and keeps systems running, balancing security, compliance, and usability.
Top Priority	Ensure IT initiatives deliver measurable clinical, operational, and financial value.	Position the organization for sustained, long-term success.	Protect from evolving cyber threats, particularly cloud and account compromise.
Biggest Fear	Disparate legacy systems and limited EHR interoperability.	Competition from national insurers, PE, and retail health entrants.	Insufficient cybersecurity expertise and incomplete device inventories.
Trusted Metric	Demonstrated ROI from IT initiatives.	Revenue growth and market share.	Reduction in major cybersecurity incidents.
Decision Criteria	Proven EHR integration; standardized, scalable solutions.	Strategic alignment with tangible, defensible ROI.	Effectiveness against ransomware/phishing; minimal workflow disruption.

Strategic Tech Leadership

The Architect of Enterprise Value Through Technology

This is the executive who makes sure technology actually works for the health system, not just on paper but in real clinical and operational workflows. They decide what gets bought, how systems fit together, and whether technology makes work easier or harder.

WHAT KEEPS THEM UP AT NIGHT

- Tension between maintaining legacy infrastructure and modernizing the tech stack
- Cybersecurity threats and patient data privacy risks
- Recruiting, retaining, and funding skilled IT talent

WHAT TRIGGERS ACTION

- **Major System Implementations:** Mandates to modernize core platforms
- **M&A Integration:** Consolidation of disparate systems
- Directives to reduce operating costs and vendor support fees

HOW THEY EVALUATE SOLUTIONS

- Tight, proven integration with the existing EHR environment
- Alignment with enterprise IT strategy; desire to reduce vendor sprawl
- Clear, demonstrable ROI and minimal disruption to clinical workflows

ENGAGEMENT IMPLICATIONS

- Lead with EHR integration and interoperability
- Show understanding of their technology roadmap
- Be prepared to discuss security, scalability, and total cost of ownership

Strategic Tech Leadership

Organizational Context & Success Metrics

COMMON TITLES

CIO | SVP & CIO | CDIO | CDO | CTO | CHIO | VP of IT

WORKING RELATIONSHIPS

REPORTS TO
CEO, COO, or CFO (varies by structure)

SUPERVISES
CISO, CAO, PMO, CMIO, CDAO, Chief AI Officer

COLLABORATORS
Executive leadership, clinical leadership, CSO, vendors

KEY COMMITTEES

- IT Governance Committee
- Enterprise Architecture Review Board
- Digital Transformation Steering Committee
- Capital Planning Committee

GOALS & PRIORITIES

- Deliver measurable value from IT initiatives
- Execute major system implementations
- Strengthen cybersecurity posture
- Improve interoperability across systems
- Support revenue cycle through technology
- Lead cloud migration and consolidation

SUCCESS METRICS

- ROI from IT initiatives and investments
- Reduction in operating costs from IT optimization
- Revenue cycle performance improvements
- Cybersecurity posture and risk reduction
- Patient access and digital engagement
- Burnout reduction linked to tech improvements

PERCEIVED BARRIERS

- Disparate legacy systems and apps
- Limited EHR integration across solutions
- IT talent recruitment and retention
- Competing capital priorities
- Cybersecurity and AI adoption concerns
- Constrained bandwidth and capacity

Strategic Tech Leadership

Decision Architecture & Content Preferences

DECISION CRITERIA

- Clear, demonstrable return on investment
- Proven success with comparable healthcare organizations
- Alignment with enterprise IT strategy and broader goals
- Tight integration with existing EHR environment
- Desire to rationalize and reduce vendor count
- Initial preference for existing vendors, particularly EHR partners
- Minimal disruption to clinical and operational workflows

BUSINESS INITIATIVES

- **Leads:** Digital transformation for patient care and operational efficiency
- **Leads:** Large-scale system implementations and optimization
- **Leads:** Cybersecurity maturity initiatives
- **Participates:** Organizational growth (M&A, joint ventures)
- **Participates:** Financial planning tied to tech investments
- **Participates:** Population health and value-based care initiatives

PREFERRED CONTENT TYPES

- Product demonstrations and solution walkthroughs
- Case studies, white papers, and solution briefs
- Peer-focused executive briefings and roundtables

INFORMATION SOURCES

- Vendor websites and technical documentation
- In-person conferences and executive forums
- Healthcare and technology publications
- Peer networks and trusted influencers
- Educational webinars and virtual briefings

Strategy Executive

The Navigator of Future Growth

This role is focused on where the organization is going, not just next year, but five years out. They connect market trends, growth opportunities, digital strategy, and financial realities into a single direction. Most of what they do influences decisions, even if they are not the one signing the contract.

WHAT KEEPS THEM UP AT NIGHT

- Growing competition from national insurers, PE, and retail health
- Operating with tight budgets amid pressure to invest in new technology
- Difficulty unifying culture and operations following M&A activity

WHAT TRIGGERS ACTION

- **Market Expansion:** Mergers, acquisitions, or service line expansion
- **Competitive Threats:** New competitors stealing market share
- **Strategic Planning:** Long-range cycles requiring new revenue models

HOW THEY EVALUATE SOLUTIONS

- Clear strategic alignment with enterprise business outcomes
- Tangible, defensible ROI tied to strategic priorities
- Ability to scale across diverse service lines and operating models

ENGAGEMENT IMPLICATIONS

- Align value proposition with long-term competitive positioning
- Provide "board-ready" strategy briefs and investment cases
- Demonstrate how the solution enables scalable growth or efficiency

Strategy Executive

Organizational Context & Success Metrics

COMMON TITLES

- CSO
- SVP/EVP of Strategy
- VP Strategy & Growth
- Chief Transformation Officer

WORKING RELATIONSHIPS

REPORTS TO
President or CEO

SUPERVISES
Strategic planning, business development, performance improvement, analytics

COLLABORATORS
Board of directors, CFO, COO, CTO, CNO, CMO

KEY COMMITTEES

- Executive Leadership Team
- Strategic Planning Committee
- M&A / Growth Steering Committee
- Service Line Expansion Councils

GOALS & PRIORITIES

- Position for sustained, long-term success
- Improve access to care across service lines
- Drive operational efficiency in care delivery
- Execute strategic cost management
- Define and advance enterprise AI strategy
- Retain and grow the patient base

SUCCESS METRICS

- ROI from enterprise strategic initiatives
- Revenue growth and margin performance
- Market share and competitive positioning
- Operational efficiency and productivity gains
- Patient outcomes and quality/safety scores
- Consumer engagement and trust

PERCEIVED BARRIERS

- Constrained budgets with pressure to invest
- Volatile supplemental funding (Medicaid, 340B)
- Staffing shortages and clinician burnout
- Post-M&A culture and ops unification
- Clinician skepticism toward new tech
- Rapidly evolving regulatory requirements

Information Security Leadership

The Shield Against Digital Threats

This is the executive responsible for protecting patient data and keeping systems running in the face of constant cyber threats. They balance security, compliance, and usability while preparing for incidents everyone hopes will not happen.

WHAT KEEPS THEM UP AT NIGHT

- Ransomware, cloud compromise, and third-party risk management
- Incomplete asset inventories, particularly for medical devices
- Perception of the CISO as a blocker rather than a business partner

WHAT TRIGGERS ACTION

- **Security Incidents:** A breach that elevates risk awareness
- **Audit Failures:** Poor findings from compliance audits
- Introduction of new risks via cloud migration or AI adoption

HOW THEY EVALUATE SOLUTIONS

- Proven effectiveness against top threats (ransomware, phishing)
- Alignment with NIST and HPH Cybersecurity Performance Goals
- Minimal disruption to clinical and operational workflows

ENGAGEMENT IMPLICATIONS

- Lead with security architecture, compliance, and risk reduction
- Prove that security controls will not degrade operational usability
- Be transparent about third-party security and audit support

Information Security Leadership

Organizational Context & Decision Architecture

COMMON TITLES

- CISO
- Director of Info Security
- VP of Cybersecurity

WORKING RELATIONSHIPS

REPORTS TO
CIO (in high-risk orgs: direct to CEO)

DOTTED LINE
Audit Committee / Board

SUPERVISES
Security Ops, GRC, IAM, Third-Party Risk

KEY COMMITTEES

- Cybersecurity / Risk Committee
- IT Governance
- Incident Response Council
- Board Audit or Risk Committee

DECISION CRITERIA

- Proven effectiveness against top threat vectors
- Alignment with NIST, HPH CPGs, and HIPAA requirements
- Minimal disruption to clinical workflows
- Strong vendor security posture and audit transparency
- Integration with existing security stack and SIEM

PERCEIVED BARRIERS

- Insufficient in-house cybersecurity expertise
- Incomplete asset inventories for connected devices
- Expanding attack surface from cloud and IoMT
- Budget constraints competing with clinical priorities
- Difficulty quantifying security ROI for the board